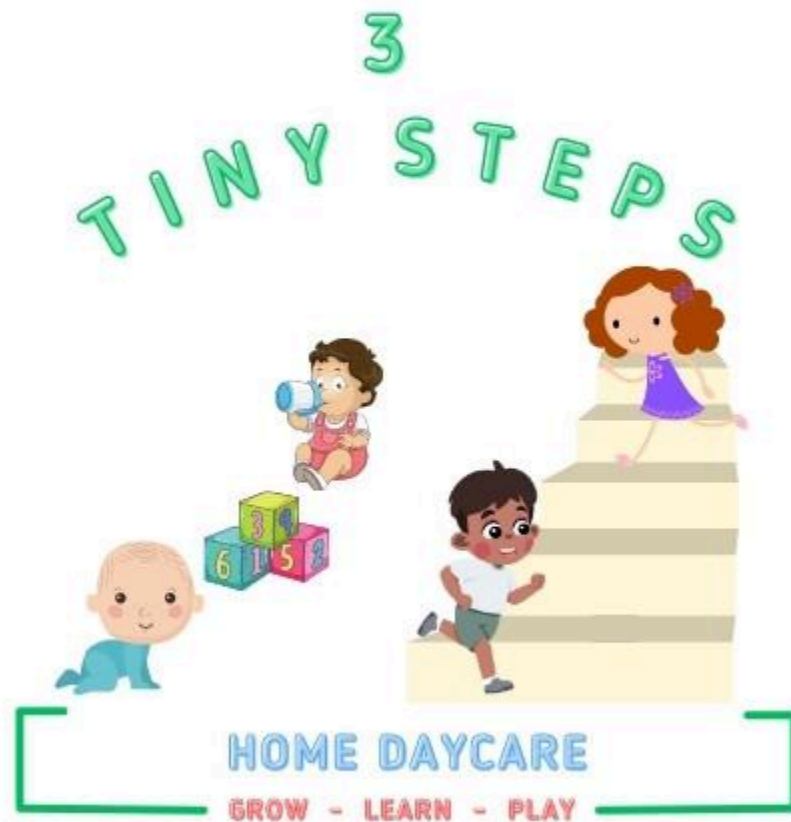


Parent Handbook and Agreement



Welcome! In choosing 3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare, you've chosen the best for your child - the quality infant/toddler program in the comfort of the home environment! 3 Tiny Steps is committed to providing high quality care; a place where your child can grow in all areas of development - social / emotional, physical, and cognitive . This place is where your child will receive the love and care to support building self esteem, independence, and success. Thank you for sharing your child with 3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare. May we all have a wonderfully positive daycare experience!

Please be aware that *3 Tiny Steps* Parent handbook and tuition is **subject to change**. In the situation that terms change, parents will be notified.

I. HOURS OF OPERATION

3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare will be open to children from 7:30 a.m. until 5:00 p.m. Monday through Friday. 3 Tiny Steps closes promptly at 5:00 p.m. After 5:00, a late fee will be assessed at the rate of \$15.00 per 15 minutes.

II. HOLIDAY/VACATION SCHEDULE

3 Tiny Steps closes for the following holidays:

- New Year's Day
- Martin Luther King Day
- President's Day
- Good Friday
- Memorial Day
- Juneteenth
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Columbus Day
- Veteran's Day
- Thanksgiving
- Day after Thanksgiving
- Christmas Eve
- Christmas Day
- New Year's Eve

*** Summer break will be taken during the beginning of July - exact dates to be determined and families will be notified in advance.**

III. SNOW CLOSINGS

3 Tiny Steps will make every effort to open as usual in inclement weather. Should the weather threaten to be so severe that safe passage is not possible, a delayed opening or early closing may be unavoidable. A closing for the full day will be utilized only as a last resort. (Note: Because tuition is calculated on an annual basis, tuition is due regardless of school closings). You will be notified by telephone as early as possible should any of the above take place.

IV. ILLNESS

In the event that 3 Tiny Steps must close due to illness in the family (teacher or teacher's family), tuition will not be charged for that day. Before closing, every effort will be made to provide a substitute for the day. Please note that if your child is absent due to illness, because tuition is calculated on an annual basis, tuition is due regardless of such absence.

V. DAILY SCHEDULE

7:00 AM - 8:00 AM: Arrival & Welcome Play

Diapering & Potty Prep
Gentle check-ins as children arrive and settle into morning free play

8:00 AM - 8:30 AM: Morning Breakfast

Fueling up for the morning
A healthy breakfast to start the day together

8:30 AM - 10:30 AM: Morning Discovery

Storytime, Music, Movement
Structured group activities including reading, dancing, and classroom

9:00 AM - 9:30 AM: Infant Nap Time

10:30 AM - 12:00 PM: Outdoor Exploration & Gross Motor Play

Gross motor play and fresh air
Time spent outside on the playground building physical strength and socializing

12:00 PM - 1:00 PM: Nourishing Lunch

Enjoying a Healthy Lunch
Nutritious lunch together while practicing healthy eating habits and independence

1:00 PM - 1:30 PM: Quiet Transition & Rest Preparation

Diapering/Potty Prep & Fresh Change
Fresh changes, potty support, and calming activities to prepare for rest

1:30 PM - 3:30 PM: Rest & Nap Time

Recharging minds and bodies
Quiet environment for all children to rest

3:30 PM - 4:00 PM: Afternoon Snack Time

Healthy Afternoon fuel
Nutritious and refreshing afternoon snack to fuel up for the rest of the day's activities

4:00 PM - 5:00 PM: Open Ended Playtime

Child-led exploration
Free play in our learning center or outdoors facility, encouraging creativity, sharing, and peer-to-peer social skills

5:00 PM - 5:30 PM: Wrap up and Dismissal

Departure and daily updates

VI. OUTDOOR PLAY

Outdoor play is an important part of a child's day. Children need fresh air, sunlight, and the freedom of outdoor play in all seasons. Children will play outside daily except in cases of rain or extremely cold weather (determined by the Teacher).

Parents are responsible for providing appropriate outdoor clothing for their children. In the daycare situation, the child who is too sick to go outside is considered too sick to be at the daycare. Even in winter months, short periods of outdoor time are vital to maintain good health.

VII. NUTRITION/ MEALS

Good nutrition is vital to a child's health and growth. 3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare supports this by providing nutritious snacks, fruits, and vegetables. It is REQUIRED parents provide lunch for their child. For those children who are formula/breast milk, parents are asked to provide formula or breast milk. Families supply baby food as well. If your child has any allergies, please let our staff know and include them on the enrollment forms.

VIII. TUITION RATE SCHEDULE

Tuition is due weekly at the beginning of the week, no exceptions. Payments may be given directly to your child's provider. If tuition has not been paid in two successive weeks, it'll result in your child's enrollment being dropped.

1 week late - Warning

2 weeks late - Dropped enrollment

Tuition rates are determined based on each child's individual needs, the level of support or accommodations required, and the services and care our program is able to provide.

Premium Time

The hours of 7:00 - 7:30 and 5:00 - 5:30 are premium times, and an additional fee is charged for children attending during these times. The fee is \$10. If your child will attend during premium time, you must notify your child's provider ahead of time,

otherwise, overtime fee will be charged. Payment for premium time is due in cash on the day charges are incurred.

Deposit

Parent(s) have a 15 day period to decide whether or not to enroll their child. If deciding to continue the enrollment process, a deposit in the amount of one weeks payment rate is due on the first day of enrollment. This deposit is applied to your child last week in the program.

Any questions regarding your account are to be addressed to your child's provider.

IX. ATTENDANCE

Each child is enrolled for a specified and scheduled number of days. Because tuition rates are set on an annual basis, tuition is due regardless of absence. If your child will be absent on a scheduled day please call 3 Tiny Steps as soon as possible to notify the teacher.

X. TERMINATION OF ENROLLMENT

One month prior to withdrawing your child from 3 Tiny Steps, for any reason, a withdrawal form must be completed and signed by both the parent(s) and the director.

All outstanding balances must be paid in full prior to the child's last day of attendance at 3 Tiny Steps.

Enrollment will not be considered terminated until the withdrawal form has been received and signed by all parties by 3 Tiny Steps. Thus, tuition will be charged as usual as the child will be considered enrolled in the program.

Parents will have the option to use their enrollment deposit to pay the last week of attendance of their child.

XI. ARRIVAL AND DEPARTURE

A. Arrival

Each child must be accompanied into the program by an adult and signed in on the sign in / out sheet. You'll be welcomed by your teacher on duty. Feel free to spend some time with us before you begin your work day. Please remember to share any important information, such as how your child ate and slept, was he/she given any medication this morning (or will need any to be administered during the day - see policy), is someone other than the parent picking the child up (must be listed on the emergency form or notify 3 Tiny Steps in writing), and other information that may affect your child's day.

B. Departure

Each child must be accompanied out of the center by a parent or authorized adult and signed out on the sign in/out sheet. The teacher on duty will discuss the day with you. Please remember to go check your child's cubby for notes and belongings to go home.

- For your protection in the protection of your child, 3 Tiny Steps will not release your child to anyone who is not authorized to pick him/her up. Those people who you wish to authorize to pick up your child must be listed on your Emergency Form. If someone is scheduled to pick up your child and he/she is not listed on the form, you must give us a written notice, including the name of the person who will be picking up your child, the date, and your signature. In extreme emergencies, when a written notice cannot be given, 3 Tiny Steps requires a telephone call from you, with the name of the person picking up your child and the driver's license number of that person. Any person picking up your child will be required to show legal ID with a picture, such as a driver's license and leave a signature on the sign in/out sheet.

XII. MEDICATIONS

Assigned staff at 3 Tiny Steps have completed a state approved medication administration course, and keep this certificate current. These staff members will administer medications under the following conditions:

1. All medications must be accompanied by a completed medication administration form prepared and signed by both the child's pediatrician and the parent. (A

standing order is required at the time of enrollment for fever reducing medications such as tylenol, cold/cough medication, sunscreen, and diaper rash medication such as Desitin.)

2. Medication must be stored in the original container and labeled with the child's full name.
3. The first dosage of each medication must be given at home as a precaution in case of allergic reaction.

Medication Administration forms can be obtained by speaking with a teacher on duty. A form must be completed for all medications

XIII. HEALTH POLICIES

3 Tiny Steps takes every precaution possible to keep all children as healthy as possible. These include enforcing health policies, proper hand washing techniques, use of gloves, disinfecting toys and surfaces in the classroom, frequent cleaning and laundering, and notifying parents when children may have been exposed to a contagious illness. Some illness is inevitable in a group setting, but by working together, parents and teachers can do a great deal to ensure a healthy environment for the children. When deciding whether or not to bring your child to 3 Tiny Steps due to illness, please keep in mind the “shoe on the other foot” theory. How would you feel if another child came into the daycare sick, thus potentially spreading the illness to your child?

In accordance with guidelines set by the American Academy of Pediatrics, Center for Disease Control, and National Association for the Education of young children, 3 Tiny Steps Health policy is as follows:

- Fever of 101° or above, with or without accompanying symptoms
- Fever less than 101° and/or any of the following symptoms:
 - Diarrhea (unrelated to teething)
 - Vomiting abdominal pain
 - Too sick participate normally in the days activities, including going outside
 - Excessive cold symptoms
 - Other unexplained pain or discomfort

The exclusion timetable is as follows:

Your child may return when:

- Fever - fever under 100° for 24 hours without fever reducing medications
- Chicken pox - when all lesions have been scabbed over (usually 7- 10 days)
- Conjunctivitis (pink eye) - can return once treatment starts
- Strep throat / scarlet fever - 24 hours after treatment starts
- Ear infection - when excessive cold symptoms disappear in children is on medication
- Impetigo - day after treatment starts
- Diarrhea - 24 hours diarrhea free
- Vomiting - 24 hours vomiting free
- Lice/Ringworms/ Scabies - day after treatment starts

When 3 Tiny Steps notifies you to pick up your child due to illness, you're expected to arrive within the hour. A late fee will be assessed in the event that the child is not picked up within the hour. If it is not possible for you to arrive in the designated time frame, please have a local backup person/people you can rely on as an alternative. These people should be listed on the emergency form for emergency pickup

XIV. EMERGENCY PROCEDURE

If your child should become injured or seriously injured while at 3 Tiny Steps, the procedure below will be followed:

1. The teacher on duty will assess the situation and administer First Aid and/or CPR if deemed appropriate.
2. In very serious cases, the teacher will dial 911 for emergency treatment and/or transportation. An emergency backup person will be called in to remain with other children, so that the teacher can accompany the child to the hospital. The parent will be notified immediately and ask to meet the teacher and child at the hospital. Please note that many hospitals prefer to wait to administer treatment until the parent has been contacted whenever possible, even when a daycare program has a

completed emergency form. For this reason, if you cannot be reached at your regular work number for an extended period of time, please leave an alternative phone number where you can be reached, or call to check in from time to time.

3. In all other cases, the teacher will attempt to notify the parent(s). If the parent(s) cannot be reached, a person listed on the emergency form will be contacted.

4. In cases of injury, you will be notified as follows:

MINOR INJURIES: (scrapes, bruises, cuts) - you will be notified verbally, at pick up time, or by the phone during the day if appropriate. An accident log is kept here on file with date, time, description, and treatment, if any. The injury may also be noted on your home report.

MORE SERIOUS INJURIES: (Required medication treatment or may develop further in the evening hours) - an accident form will be completed by the teacher and signed by both the teacher and the parent, the original form will be kept on a file at 3 Tiny Steps, and a copy will be given to the parent.

5. Emergency services will be provided at the hospital or medical facility deemed appropriate by emergency personnel responding to the call.

XV. FIRE DRILLS

Fire drills are held once a month. the procedure below is as followed:

1. The teacher gathers children and escorts them out to the nearest safe exit. *Please see evacuation routes posted in the classroom. *
2. A head count is taken at the door and then again once outside. The teacher takes the portable First Aid kit.

In the situation there is an emergency evacuation, children will be walked over to Oak Hills Golf Course and parent(s) will be contacted.

XVI. THINGS FROM HOME

Parents are expected to supply the following items:

- Disposable diapers and wipes
- Breakfast and lunch
- Formula or breast milk and bottles - filled and ready to heat

- At least two complete seasonally appropriate changes of clothes
- Bathing suit and towel in the summer months
- Sunscreen
- Tylenol or other fever reducing medication
- Diaper rash cream

Please refrain from bringing in toys from home, except for show and tell days. 3 Tiny Steps provides an ample amount of developmentally appropriate toys.

* NO war toys under any circumstance

* Please leave ALL valuable jewelry at home. 3 Tiny Steps will not be held responsible for any jewelry or valuables if lost.

XVII. BEDDING

This Family Daycare Home provides a portable crib for each child. Blankets and small pillows will not be provided for cots, please bring a blanket and/or pillow that will be left in your child's cubby. For infants it is advised you bring a onesie to help them when sleeping.

XVIII. DISCIPLINE POLICY

Part one: Classroom Discipline

Redirection is one way to help a child to develop his/her own self-control and boundaries. 3 Tiny Steps fosters this development through clear and simple explanations, rules and boundaries appropriate to the child's abilities, and encouraging children to develop conflict resolution skills, rather than lots of "NO" and "DON'T", 3 Tiny Steps prefers to let children know what's "not okay", or "not acceptable", explain why, and give the child appropriate choices instead. Occasionally a child may need to be removed from the situation to sit for a short time until he/she is ready to rejoin the group. In the event that a child's behavior becomes excessive, posing a danger to him/herself or to the other children, intervention steps must be quickly taken. This may include (not necessarily in this order):

- Conference with teacher and parents to discuss possible solutions
- Adjusting schedule to less days or less hours per day
- Withdrawal from 3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare

Part Two: Administration/ Abuse by Staff Member

Your children's safety and well-being is of utmost importance to us. In the unlikely event that a staff member is suspected of or observed abusing a child, swift and immediate action will be taken, and will include the following:

- The person who witnessed alleged abuse will interrupt the interactions between the teacher and child immediately, and ensure that the child is removed to a safe location. The witness will immediately report to the director/teacher, documenting, in writing, what he/she observed. The parent(s) will be notified by the director/teacher and apprised of the situation
- The staff member in question will be immediately removed from any and all duties that place him or her in direct contact with the children. Said staff member will remain unpaid leave until an investigation is complete
- A thorough investigation will be conducted by the director / teacher, with assistance from state licensers, DCF, law enforcement officials, social service, and/or educational consultants, and legal counsel. The investigation will include, but not be limited to: date, time, place of occurrence; witnesses accounts, means by which the abuse was immediately stopped in steps to ensure the child's safety; status of accused employment during the investigation, any and all communications with the parent, related medical reports, etc.
- In the event that the investigation substantiates the reported abuse, said employee will be terminated immediately. In addition, all information will be related to law enforcement agencies, state licensing departments and DCF.
- Social Service consultation will be available throughout this process for staff, parents, and children.

Part Three: Mandated Reports

In accordance with CT State Law, all staff working in a child care program, regardless of position, are classified as state mandated reporters. We are required by law to report any suspect abuse or neglect as defined by CT Law (CGS 46-b-120). Our legal responsibility requires we do in good faith, to protect the child. We are not responsible to investigate, question parents, or to notify parents that such report will be made. When we must file a report, it is done so with extreme care and good judgment, and is often a heart-wrenching step for us to take. Our role is not to punish, alienate, or betray the trust of the parent, but to ensure the child's safety and well being. Know that we will support the family throughout this process in any way we can, to ensure the best possible outcome for the child's involved.

XIX. GOSSIP

3 Tiny Steps, takes great pride in providing a professional, supportive, and respectful environment for all our families. Gossip about the program, other families, or staff members will not be tolerated. Any parent who engages in such behavior, will have their child's enrollment terminated immediately. As is always the case, deposits are non-refundable. Any tuition pre-paid will be refunded, with exclusion of this non-refundable deposit.

XX. STAFF MEMBER SERVICES OUTSIDE SCHOOL HOURS

3 Tiny Steps will not accept any liability or responsibility for the actions of our staff outside school hours. Such situations include, but are not limited to babysitting, house sitting, pet care, and social events.

XXI. SAFE DRIVING

Our program is located in a residential area with many families who have young children. It is common for some of these children to be playing in or near the street. Although we do not allow the children in our school to engage in such unsafe practices, we cannot govern what other families allow their children to do. PLEASE use extreme caution when driving up and down the street, driving slowly and carefully, and being alert for children who may dart out into the street.

XXII. COMMUNICATION

A daily home report will be provided for you to give you a summary of your child's day. This may include information about activities we did, special interest of the day, any “boo-boo’s” and first aid given, your child's mood (if it differs from the “norm”), eating and sleeping schedules, diapering schedules (when appropriate), and reminders. This is just one tool used to create an open communication. phone calls during the day are welcome, in parent-teacher conferences (in addition to those listed below) can be scheduled at any time. If at any time you have a concern, question, suggestion (or compliment!), PLEASE don't hesitate to speak up. Your child's daycare experience will be at its best when we can discuss issues openly.

Two other forms of communication 3 Tiny Steps uses are:

Parent-Teacher Conferences - held twice yearly (Nov and June).

Open Door Policy - 3 Tiny Steps is open to all parents at any time during normal school hours (8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m) without prior notice. Stop at ANY TIME! Come in for a special activity, or just pop in if you have the time and are in the area. If you work too far away to stop in, feel free to call us as often as you like to check on your child's day, or so speak with him/her. You should feel free that 3 Tiny Steps is as much of a home away from you as it is for your child (during school hours only, please!).

XXIII. CONSULTANTS

Although Family Daycare programs are not required to have consultants available, 3 Tiny Steps believes that this is a valuable component of a quality program. Therefore, an educational consultant, a social service consultant, pediatric consultant, and nutrition consultant are available to 3 Tiny Steps on an “as needed basis”.

3 Tiny Steps Home Daycare

Program Philosophy

3 Tiny Steps philosophy is based on a developmental approach to Child Development and learning.

The program's philosophy is characterized by certain principles:

- Quality child care reflects an interest in the whole child, which includes social/emotional, physical, and cognitive development. Children go through sequential stages in each area of development, one level forming the foundation for the next. Thus, many opportunities for this sequential growth are provided. As children gain mastery of new skills in all areas of development, the program changes to reflect the new-found abilities.
- Children learn in several different ways, each one with his or her own unique strengths in eight areas of intelligence: musical, logical-mathematical, interpersonal, spatial, intrapersonal, bodily-kinesthetic, linguistic and naturalist. The curriculum is planned to promote each of those strengths so that all children may be given optimal chances for learning and growth. This theory is referred to as the Multiple Intelligences Theory.
- The secure attachment in relationships developed in the first years of life serve as a prerequisite for a child's optimal growth, and emotional well-being. Social interactions with a consistent, responsive adult, as well as other children, are of primary importance.
- Child-center curriculum is built upon observing and understanding each child's individual skill and interest level, and basing curriculum on these observations. The teacher draws upon what she sees and hears the children doing and discussing, then plans a broad range of related experiences for the children that are individually-appropriate as well as age-appropriate. This theory is all referred to as Emergent Curriculum.
- Each child is a very unique and special child, with an individual pattern and pace of growth, as well as individual personality, learning style, interest, and family background. Both the curriculum and teachers' interactions with each child are responsive to individual differences.
- 3 Tiny Steps believes in the importance of teaching the value of growing, learning, and playing, together as one